Remote Work Makes Knowledge Workers More Productive

Essay draft — Organizational Psychology seminar

Introduction

Since 2020, remote work has moved from a perk to a default for many knowledge workers. This essay argues that remote work makes knowledge workers more productive and that companies should abandon office mandates entirely.

Evidence

Studies show that remote employees are 47% more productive than their office-based colleagues. Without commuting, workers gain on average one extra hour per day, which they invest in focused work. Fewer interruptions from colleagues further increase deep work time.

At Acme Software, a 40-person startup in Berlin, the team switched to fully remote work in 2021. Within six months, the number of shipped features rose by 30%, and the founders reported that employees seemed happier and more engaged.

Why it works

Autonomy is a core human need. When people control where and when they work, their intrinsic motivation rises, and motivated people produce better results. Remote work therefore directly increases output.

Conclusion

The evidence clearly proves that remote work is superior for every kind of knowledge work in every company. Office mandates are therefore a mistake, and all organizations should go fully remote immediately.